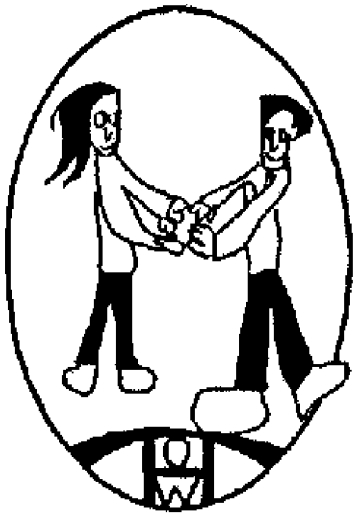
Howbridge Infant School

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History Policy
2025

Date last reviewed by Governing Body:
November 2025

Howbridge Infant School

POLICY NAME History Policy **DATE OF REVIEW November 2026**

Aims and priorities for subject teaching and learning

We provide a balanced history curriculum which matches the needs of our pupils. History is taught through half termly themed topics and is linked to other subjects within the curriculum.

- Develop the skills which enable children to find out about the past
- Develop a sense and understanding of time and chronology
- To recognise and use appropriate vocabulary and their meanings
- To help children understand society and their place within it, so that they develop a sense of their cultural heritage
- Develop children's knowledge and understanding of a variety of historical periods and different cultures and societies
- Develop children's knowledge and understanding of historical ideas and concepts – causation, change and continuity over time
- Develop children's ability to investigate and interpret the past in different ways through a variety of historical sources and techniques
- Develop children's ability to communicate their ideas and findings, in different ways, and to organise their work through a wide range of outcomes
- Understand how Britain is part of a wider European culture and to study some aspects of European and World history
- Make comparisons between their lives and the lives of people in the past
- Recall and talk about history from the area where they live
- To explore and learn about a culturally diverse selection of significant historical figures and events.

Aims:
We aim for children to develop a sense of identity through learning about the development of Britain, Europe and the world, including recognising the achievements of significant people from the past and present. Children will be assisted to understand and interpret the past.

Intention:
The intention of the teaching of history at Howbridge Infant School is to provide children with the opportunity to learn about the past and how we can use the past to move into the future. To recall important and relevant dates and events.

Impact:
All children should be able to talk about their local history and the history of significant events and people from the past. Most will be able to recall relevant and important dates. Some children will be able to make comparisons and make inferences as to why events happened and what that may mean for us now.

Sources used for the scheme of work

Planning progression is planned within the Curriculum Foundation Subject map.

History in EYFS

The key intention of the Early Years Foundation Stage Curriculum is to develop in children a keen interest in and desire to learn about the world in which they live.The Early Years Foundation Stage is underpinned by the principle that young children learn best through self-initiated and supported play. It advocates a holistic approach to teaching and learning.
In the Early Years Foundation Stage children will be given opportunities to:

- Talk about their families and past and present events in their own lives
- Show sensitivity to the needs and feelings of others
- Show respect for people of other cultures and beliefs
- Listen and respond to stories, songs, nursery rhymes and poems
- Explore objects and look closely at similarities, differences and patterns and change
- Compare, sort, match, order and sequence everyday objects
- Talk about their observations and ask questions to gain information about why things happen and how things work.

Planning will be taken from:
Early Adopter Early Learning Goals

- To talk about the lives of the people around them and their roles in society
- Know some similarities between things in the past and now, drawing on their experiences and what has been read in class.
- Understand the past through settings, characters and events encountered in books read in class and storytelling.
- Explain some similarities and differences between life in this country and life in other countries (drawing on knowledge from stories, non-fiction texts and maps)

History in KS1

In Key Stage 1 history is about the lives and lifestyles of familiar people in the recent past and about famous people and events in the more distant past, including those from British history.
Children:

- Learn about familiar and famous people and about events from the recent and more distant past in Britain and elsewhere
- Look for similarities and differences between life today and in the past and use common words associated with the passing of time
- Talk and write about what happened and why people acted as they did
- Find out about the past using different sources of information and representations.

By the end of Key Stage 1, most children will be able to:

- Speak and write about familiar and famous people and events from the recent and more distant past, using everyday terms concerned with the passing of time
- Distinguish between aspects of their own everyday lives and the lives of people in the past
- Identify some ways in which the past is represented
- Find out about the past by asking and answering questions using a range of resources of information
- To understand how to use and recognise a timeline of significant people and events.

Visitors/visits

Various topic related workshops/visits may take place during the school year.
There will also be opportunities to link school trips and visits to the different history topics throughout the year.
We will provide opportunities for special days/events related to history. E.g. Black History Month, workshops.

Strategies for teaching

Taught through discrete history lessons or as part of an overall half term topic.
Children will have opportunities to learn about past events and people of significance and to explore events in their own lifetime.
Using different strategies to teach using role play, outside learning, library, chromebooks and internet.Role Play areas will often have links to the main theme topic across the year.
Opportunities will be given across the year to research a variety of key individuals and events in a diverse way.
KS1 classes have keyrings with key vocabulary and definitions to use during teaching.
Classrooms display key vocabulary and ensure children's understanding.

Planning, marking and feedback

Learning outcomes in each unit show how children can demonstrate what they have learnt within each unit. Marking is in accordance with the schools marking policy. Oral feedback will be given to

the history coordinator as and when necessary. Work samples will be monitored annually and copies of planning with history objectives highlighted will be collected throughout the year.

The children's work serves as a record for each history unit. Teachers' comments at the end of pieces of work serve as recognition of achievement. History should be taught to extend and challenge all individuals, ensuring there are opportunities to develop further understanding and differentiate learning.
Assessment is often made by observation and listening. It is continuous and ongoing.

Objectives at the beginning of every piece of work will be displayed, whether that is in books or whole class work in floor books. These objectives can be marked using a pink pen (school marking scheme) to show that the objective has been met.

History Coordinator to monitor various pieces of work throughout the year to link to curriculum planning. Floor books and timeline displays to be visible. Classrooms will have timelines displayed which are added to overtime to show the significant people and events that have been covered, demonstrating where they should go chronologically.

Year 1 and 2 will work together annually to ensure progression of learning and overall key stage 1 coverage. Each year group will try to build on the previous year's knowledge.

Assessment, recording and reporting

Assessment will be made in accordance with the End of Key Stage Descriptions in the National Curriculum. Children will be observed throughout history lessons as part of their assessment. Photographs or whole class floor books may also be used to record activities and progress.
Long term history map of topics is also recorded to demonstrate progression of learning e.g. EYFS People who help us, Y1 Heroes (nurses, police, fireman), Y2 Great fire of London (fireservice) Mary Seacole (nurse) - just as one example.
Assessment to be recorded using Sonar assessment program. To be kept up to date throughout the year.

Inclusion - equal opportunities, racial awareness, gender, gifted and talented, SEN

We aim to set suitable learning targets, respond to pupil's diverse needs and overcome potential barriers to learning and assessment for groups and individuals and follow the guidance set out in The National Curriculum Handbook, key stage 1 and 2. The children's entitlement is based upon the programmes of study as defined in the Statutory Orders. All children regardless of race, gender and ability, will be given equal access to history. Classroom management takes account of such issues and classroom materials free from bias will be positively sought.

Foundation assessment sheets will record whether children have met expectations/ levels according to national curriculum objectives.
Mastery should record children's understanding beyond classroom expectations. This could be done through photographs, mastery moment slips or displays.

Mastery/Monitoring

To achieve greater depth/mastery

- A range of resources to be used, appropriate for the different levels of ability.
- Extension and/or more challenging tasks to be provided.
- Greater independence in working e.g. pupils who are able to do so should be encouraged to carry out their own simple historical investigations.
- Ability to use appropriate vocabulary and understand their meanings
- To ask questions which challenge each child's understanding and for children to make more in depth enquiries.
- Opportunities through challenge cards, quizzes etc. to record children's prior understanding and learning.

Support for History delivery and resourcing is provided by the history coordinator. New resource requirements to be passed on to the history subject leader.
New resources shared with the rest of school staff when need arises.

Many opportunities given for children to ask and answer both open and closed questions. To go deeper into a topic to reveal new information and to keep up interest in a topic.
Children to develop skills in mastery of history. Applying their knowledge of some events and comparing with events in their own life; being able to recall important dates and events and understand fully about chronology of dates.

Links with other subjects

There are strong cross curricular links with subjects through the teaching of half termly topics. These links can be identified on each year group's curricular maps.
Reading and writing are essential for the processes of finding out about and communicating an understanding of history, Discussion, drama and role play are important aspects of the programmes of study for speaking and listening and are important ways for children to develop their understanding that people have different viewpoints and perspectives on history.
Presentation, data handling, information retrieved and Internet use are highlighted in the history planning, iPads are used to record visits, local walks and classroom follow up. ICT will provide access to a range of information sources which may not be available in other forms. ICT will support the development of the understanding of historical patterns and processes. It can assist in the analysis of historical data. Chrome books can be used to research different topics independently.

Staff and school development
Staff and school development needs are identified through school evaluation and development planning and Performance management reviews. Areas for review and development are identified through group and whole staff discussion and supported by school-led training, either led by history coordinator or from outside providers, as and when needed/available.
Review
This policy will be reviewed annually as part of the subject development programme. It will be re-drafted periodically as necessary taking account of the school's development plan and new local and national curriculum requirements